Cognitive functional therapy for disabling low back pain: a multidimensional ap

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Clinical Focus: Spine | Open Access Clinical Reference

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1. Biopsychosocial Framing of Persistent Spinal Pain

Persistent non-specific low back pain is driven by complex interactions between structural, psychological, and social factors.
Structural MRI findings (e.g. disc degeneration, mild bulges) are prevalent in asymptomatic individuals and must be contextualized.

2. Core Dimensions of Cognitive Functional Therapy (CFT)

â¢ Making Sense of Pain: Demystifying spinal mechanics, addressing diagnostic scan anxiety, and breaking fear-avoidance beliefs.
â¢ Exposure with Control: Graded behavioral exposure to avoided movements (lumbar flexion, loaded lifting) while de-tensing muscles.
â¢ Lifestyle Integration: Addressing sleep deficits, systemic stress, physical inactivity, and pacing strategies.

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